Los Angeles Times

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‘A generational remake’ from the left

Democrats’ historic triumph was fueled by a rare coalition of voters.

By Justine McDaniel and Michael Wilner

WASHINGTON — Democrats heralded a new era in American politics Wednesday after voters broke Republicans’ control of government and delivered a pivotal rebuke of President Trump.

Victories that handed Democrats control of the House and Senate on Tuesday night came in historic form, with margins outstripping expectations and double-digit shifts to the left by nearly every voting bloc. In some of the reddest states in the union, even Republican redistricting efforts designed to shield districts from competition were not enough to prevent Democratic inroads.

The sweeping wins were driven by a rare coalition of voters across nearly all walks of American life, in cities and countryside, from the rural Midwest and Deep South to a traditionally conservative mid-Atlantic. Not since voters were repulsed by President Nixon after the Watergate scandal half a century ago has the popular vote swung so decisively in a single election cycle.

The wave was so comprehensive that it handed Democrats wins that for decades had been unthinkable — flipping Senate seats in Kansas, South Carolina and Texas — and a majority of governors’ seats for the

[See **Democrats,** A6]



Chip Somodevilla Getty Images

SUPPORTERS of Democratic Sen.-elect James Talarico celebrate as they watch election returns in Texas.

RAMAN IS POISED TO WIN, ANALYSTS PREDICT

By Noah Goldberg, Noah Haggerty and Clara Harter

A jubilant Nithya Raman stood before cheering supporters at her election night party Tuesday, giving a speech that fell just shy of declaring victory, but one that urged the crowd at the Greek Theatre plaza to hold off on the celebrations for now.

“I’m hopeful. I’m very hopeful,” Raman told a raucous crowd fueled by tequila and chicken tenders. “I’m also really superstitious. So we’re all just going to be cool, OK? Very cool.”

The initial vote tally Tuesday had Raman slightly behind incumbent Karen Bass in the race for Los Angeles mayor, but analysts were quick to point out that this was actually a strong indication that Raman would win. Polls have consistently shown Raman is heavily favored by younger voters, who tend to vote later than older people and whose late-arriving ballots are considered likely to turn the tide in her favor.

“The expectation is that once Nithya Raman starts gaining votes she will continue to gain votes. There is not going to be a seesaw. It is likely going to be pretty unidirectional,” said Paul Mitchell, who heads the polling data firm PDI. “I don’t call races. But if that expectation holds true, then there is no reason to expect that Raman is going to do anything but gain votes from here.”

Votes were still being counted the day after the election, but by early Wednesday morning, Raman had taken a slight lead over Bass. She grew that lead by a percentage point Wednesday afternoon as more ballots were counted, with about 52% of the vote compared with Bass’ 48%. Raman is now up by more than 25,000 votes.

“Nithya Raman is going to win. She’s going to be our next mayor,” said a gleeful L.A. County Supervisor Lindsey Horvath, who has clashed with Bass and endorsed Raman a few weeks before the election.

“It’s over,” declared Estevan Montemayor, who ran an independent expenditure group supporting Raman.

Across town at the Loews Hollywood Hotel, Bass projected confidence on Tues-

[See **Raman,** A9]

What will define the ‘Becerra era’?

By Nicole Nixon

California is about to enter the “Becerra era,” though the governor-elect who coined that phrase has dropped few hints about what will define it.

After a decisive Tuesday night victory in the race to succeed termed-out Gov. Gavin Newsom, Xavier Becerra will take the helm with a slate of potential economic opportunities: luring back Hollywood production, drawing international visitors to the 2028 Olympic Games, implementing voter-approved housing bonds and responsibly growing the artificial intelligence industry.

But a long list of challenges awaits: grappling with worst-in-the-nation unemployment, solving the housing crisis, and preparing for and responding to seemingly endless fires, floods and other natural disasters.

The optimistic 68-year-old told supporters gathered for his campaign party in West Sacramento that his mission is to “deliver a California we can afford and defend a California we can’t afford to lose.”

“Here’s the good news,” Becerra, a Democrat, told the packed and cheering crowd. “Californians don’t expect a miracle from government; they just want government that works. A government that can build things. A government that keeps our streets clean and schools safe. Basic services delivered on time and on budget.”

Easier said than done.

[See **Becerra,** A10]



Andri Tambunan For The Times

CALIFORNIA Gov.-elect Xavier Becerra grasps supporters’ hands during an election night party.

ELECTION 2026

Totals as of 4:30 p.m. Wednesday

LOS ANGELES MAYOR



Nithya Raman (D)
51.7%

Karen Bass (D)
48.3%

Estimated 66.6% of vote in

STATEWIDE MEASURES

Proposition 40
No
55.3%
Yes
44.7%
Estimated 60.9% of vote in

Proposition 39
✓ No
58.9%
Yes
41.1%
Estimated 60.8% of vote in

CALIFORNIA GOVERNOR



✓ Xavier Becerra (D)
64.2%

Steve Hilton (R)
35.8%

Estimated 60.6% of vote in

120TH CONGRESS

House of Representatives
218 seats needed to control the House

Democrats	Republicans	Uncalled
237	147	51

Senate
51 seats needed to control the Senate

Democrats	Republicans	Uncalled
54	44	2

On the web: Vote counts update periodically as results are reported by the Associated Press and the county registrars. Find our most up-to-date results at *latimes.com*.

New focus on reining in Trump and prices

By Ana Ceballos and Justine McDaniel

WASHINGTON — Democrats in Congress gained the power Tuesday night to more forcefully investigate President Trump and rein in his agenda, setting up confrontations that are likely to define the final two years of his presidency.

As party leaders on Wednesday celebrated retaking the House and Senate, they vowed to put Trump and his administration on the defensive with subpoenas and hearings, a role that voters made clear they want them to play. But they also said the top priority would be the issue that swept them to power: making life more affordable.

“We are going to work hard to drive costs down with the president or without him, period,” Sen. Chuck Schumer, who is poised to become Senate majority leader, said at a news conference.

Schumer’s fellow New Yorker and the House Democratic leader, Rep. Hakeem Jeffries, echoed those priorities on CNN: “We ran on affordability, we won decisively on affordability, and now we have a responsibility to govern on affordability.”

With power split between the legislative and executive branches, to what degree Washington avoids gridlock will depend on how Trump wields his veto pen and how

[See **Focus,** A8]

Why the billionaire tax fell short in California

By Queenie Wong and Seema Mehta

Despite a nationwide blue wave in the midterm election, California’s much-debated billionaire tax didn’t get the support many expected in one of the country’s most liberal states.

Since the Golden State’s powerful healthcare union proposed the new tax, supporters of Proposition 40 have faced a fierce, expensive battle against the world’s richest people.

In what has been described as a David-versus-Goliath fight, the underdog appears to have lost. The proposition, which would have imposed a one-time 5% tax on the assets of California billionaires to mostly fund healthcare, seemed headed toward defeat as votes were tallied Wednesday.

“In a deep blue state like California, most voters are going to support additional funding for healthcare, especially to replace Trump funding cuts. But in retrospect, the sponsors may wish they’d been a little bit less ambitious,” said Dan Schnur, a politics and communications professor at USC, UC Berkeley and Pepperdine.

In early returns, nearly 56% of voters rejected the proposal while 44% voted for Proposition 40. However, with roughly 6 million votes still needed to be counted, the results are still too close to call.

The battle over the billionaire tax has been one of the most expensive ballot-measure fights in California’s history, sparking a debate over wealth inequality and taxing the ultrawealthy. It also highlighted how billionaires have wielded more influence in politics.

Well-known politicians such as U.S. Sen. Bernie

[See **Tax,** A9]

MORE ELECTION COVERAGE INSIDE

Interference: Feared disruption by federal agents doesn’t occur. **A7**

Congress: California Democrats ace first test of new district maps. **A10**

Elon Musk: GOP donor and his companies face tough questions. **A13**

City attorney: Marissa Roy has vowed she’ll be “the people’s lawyer.” **B1**

Sheriff: Robert Luna fends off a challenge by Alex Villanueva. **B1**

Propositions: Some have been decided (no on 39); others too close to call. **B3**

Down the ballot: Democrats unsurprisingly sweep statewide races. **B3**

Inglewood: City, Rams owner claim victory as dueling measures trail. **D1**

Latino voters helped secure blue victories

By Andrea Castillo

WASHINGTON — Latino voters, whose swing to the right aided President Trump’s election in 2024, helped Democrats reclaim both chambers of Congress on Tuesday in a stunning reversal of support for Republicans.

The shift, which transpired nationwide but was especially pronounced in Texas, is seen as a rebuke of the president and his party by a group of Americans who have watched as their families and neighbors were detained by immigration agents while their cost of living shot up.

“President Trump asked voters to pretend like he was on the ballot, and our observation is that Latino voters did just that by resoundingly rejecting his extreme policies and actions and anyone who rubber-stamped them,” said Janet Murguía, president of UnidosUS, a Washington-based Latino civil rights and advocacy group.

“While the numbers are still coming in, what we know so far indicates that this will undoubtedly be the largest turnout of Latino voters ever in a midterm election,” she added.

UnidosUS on Wednesday released findings from a poll, conducted by the Los Angeles-based analytics firm BSP Research, of more than 3,000 Latinos who voted in the midterm elections. The findings showed many Latinos are independent, swing voters — 17% of 2024 Trump voters supported Democratic House candidates in this election.

Gary Segura, president of BSP Research, said on a call Wednesday with Murguía and reporters that Latino voters returned this election to historical patterns, with about two-thirds voting for Democrats and one-

[See **Latinos,** A8]

Weather
Sun, some clouds.
L.A. Basin: 81/58. **D6**

Science **A12**
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